
INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE

Unit 1 Aspects of dramatic tragedy

Tuesday 14 May 2024

07:00 GMT

Time allowed: 2 hours

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- an OxfordAQA 12-page Answer book.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Write the information required on the front of your answer book.
- Do all rough work in your answer book. Cross through any work you do not want to be marked.
- You must answer **one** question from Section A and **one** question from Section B.
- Remember to include, in both your answers, relevant comments on the authors' dramatic methods in the set texts you are studying.

Information

- The maximum mark for this paper is 50.
- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- You will be marked on your ability to:
 - use good English
 - organise information clearly
 - analyse carefully the writers' methods
 - use specialist vocabulary where appropriate.

Section A: Elizabethan and Jacobean tragedy

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Othello*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Othello
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 5 Scene 2**OTHELLO**

I am not valiant neither,
But every puny whipster gets my sword:
But why should Honour outlive Honesty?
Let it go all.

EMILIA

What did thy song bode, lady?
Hark, canst thou hear me? I will play the swan,
And die in music: [*sings*] 'willow, willow, willow'.
Moor, she was chaste; she loved thee, cruel Moor –
So come my soul to bliss, as I speak true!
So speaking as I think, alas, I die.

[*She dies*]

OTHELLO

I have another weapon in this chamber,
It is a sword of Spain, the ice-brook's temper –
O, here it is: uncle, I must come forth.

GRATIANO [*within*]

If thou attempt it, it will cost thee dear:
Thou hast no weapon, and perforce must suffer.

OTHELLO

Look in upon me then, and speak with me,
Or, naked as I am, I will assault thee.

[*Enter Gratiano*]

GRATIANO

What is the matter?

OTHELLO

Behold, I have a weapon –
A better never did itself sustain
Upon a soldier's thigh: I have seen the day,
That, with this little arm and this good sword,
I have made my way through more impediments
Than twenty times your stop. But, O vain boast!
Who can control his fate? 'Tis not so now.
Be not afraid, though you do see me weaponed;
Here is my journey's end, here is my butt,
And very sea-mark of my utmost sail.
Do you go back dismayed? 'Tis a lost fear;
Man but a rush against Othello's breast,
And he retires. Where should Othello go?
Now: how dost thou look now? O ill-starred wench!
Pale as thy smock, when we shall meet at count,
This look of thine will hurl my soul from heaven,
And fiends will snatch at it. Cold, cold, my girl!
Even like thy chastity. O cursed, cursed slave!
Whip me, ye devils,
From the possession of this heavenly sight,
Blow me about in winds, roast me in sulphur,
Wash me in steep-down gulfs of liquid fire –
O Desdemona! Dead Desdemona! Dead! O, Oh!
Oh! Oh! Oh!

[Enter Lodovico, Montano, Iago with officers guarding him, and Cassio in a chair]

LODOVICO

Where is this rash and most unfortunate man?

OTHELLO

That's he that was Othello: here I am.

LODOVICO

Where is that viper? bring the villain forth.

OTHELLO

I look down towards his feet – but that's a fable.
If that thou be'st a devil, I cannot kill thee.

[He wounds Iago]

Turn over for the next question

or

0	2
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William Shakespeare: *King Lear*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Gloucester and Edmund
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 2 Scene 1

[Enter Gloucester and others]

GLOUCESTER

Now, Edmund, where's the villain?

EDMUND

Here stood he in the dark, his sharp sword out,
Mumbling of wicked charms, conjuring the moon
To stand auspicious mistress, --

GLOUCESTER

But where is he?

EDMUND

Look, sir, I bleed.

GLOUCESTER

Where is the villain, Edmund?

EDMUND

Fled this way, sir. When by no means he could—

GLOUCESTER

Pursue him, ho! Go after.

[Exeunt others]

By no means what?

EDMUND

Persuade me to the murder of your lordship;
 But that I told him, the revenging gods
 'Gainst parricides did all their thunders bend;
 Spoke, with how manifold and strong a bond
 The child was bound to the father. Sir, in fine,
 Seeing how loathly opposite I stood
 To his unnatural purpose, with fell motion,
 With his prepared sword, he charges home
 My unprovided body, lanced mine arm:
 But when he saw my best alarumed spirits,
 Bold in the quarrel's rights, roused to the encounter,
 Or whether gasted by the noise I made,
 Full suddenly he fled.

GLOUCESTER

Let him fly far:
 Not in this land shall he remain uncaught;
 And found, dispatch. The noble duke my master,
 My worthy arch and patron, comes to-night:
 By his authority I will proclaim it,
 That he which finds him shall deserve our thanks,
 Bringing the murderous caitiff to the stake;
 He that conceals him, death.

EDMUND

When I dissuaded him from his intent,
 And found him pitched to do it, with curst speech
 I threatened to discover him. He replied,
 'Thou unpossessing bastard! dost thou think,
 If I would stand against thee, would the reposeure
 Of any trust, virtue, or worth in thee
 Make thy words faithed? No: what I should deny –
 As this I would: ay, though thou didst produce
 My very character – I'd turn it all
 To thy suggestion, plot, and damned pretence
 And thou must make a dullard of the world,
 If they not thought the profits of my death
 Were very pregnant and potential spurs
 To make thee seek it.'

GLOUCESTER

Strong and fastened villain
 Would he deny his letter? I never got him.
[Trumpets within]
 Hark, the Duke's trumpets! I know not why he comes.
 All ports I'll bar. The villain shall not scape;
 The Duke must grant me that; besides, his picture
 I will send far and near, that all the kingdom
 May have the due note of him – and of my land,
 Loyal and natural boy, I'll work the means
 To make thee capable.

or

0	3
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William Shakespeare: *Hamlet*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Ophelia, Laertes and Claudius
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 4 Scene 5

LAERTES

Hadst thou thy wits, and didst persuade revenge,
It could not move thus.

OPHELIA

You must sing 'A-down a-down'; and you call him 'a-down-a'.
O, how the wheel becomes it! It is the false steward that stole his master's daughter.

LAERTES

This nothing's more than matter.

OPHELIA

There's rosemary, that's for remembrance. Pray,
love, remember. And there is pansies, that's for thoughts.

LAERTES

A document in madness – thoughts and remembrance fitted.

OPHELIA

There's fennel for you, and columbines: there's rue
for you; and here's some for me. We may call it
herb-grace o' Sundays. O you must wear your rue with
a difference. There's a daisy. I would give you
some violets, but they withered all when my father
died. They say he made a good end.

[She sings]

For bonny sweet Robin is all my joy.

LAERTES

Thought and affliction, passion, hell itself,
She turns to favour and to prettiness.

OPHELIA

[Sings] And will he not come again?

And will he not come again?

No, no, he is dead,

Go to thy death-bed,

He never will come again.

His beard as white as snow,

All flaxen was his poll.

He is gone, he is gone,

And we cast away moan:

God ha' mercy on his soul.

And of all Christian souls, I pray God. God buy you.

[Exit]

LAERTES

Do you see this, O God?

CLAUDIUS

Laertes, I must commune with your grief,

Or you deny me right. Go but apart,

Make choice of whom your wisest friends you will,

And they shall hear and judge 'twixt you and me.

If by direct or by collateral hand

They find us touched, we will our kingdom give,

Our crown, our life, and all that we call ours,

To you in satisfaction. But if not,

Be you content to lend your patience to us,

And we shall jointly labour with your soul

To give it due content.

LAERTES

Let this be so;

His means of death, his obscure funeral –

No trophy, sword, nor hatchment o'er his bones,

No noble rite nor formal ostentation –

Cry to be heard, as 'twere from heaven to earth,

That I must call't in question.

CLAUDIUS

So you shall;

And where the offence is let the great axe fall.

I pray you, go with me.

[Exeunt]

Turn over for the next question

or

0	4
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Christopher Marlowe: *Doctor Faustus*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Faustus
- Marlowe's use of dramatic language
- the dramatic setting
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 1 Scene 1

FAUSTUS

Be a physician, Faustus. Heap up gold,
And be eternized for some wondrous cure:

[Reads]

'*Summum bonum medicinae sanitas*':

The end of physic is our body's health.
Why, Faustus, hast thou not attained that end?
Are not thy bills hung up as monuments,
Whereby whole cities have escaped the plague
And thousand desperate maladies been cured?
Yet art thou still but Faustus, and a man.
Couldst thou make men to live eternally,
Or, being dead, raise them to life again,
Then this profession were to be esteemed.
Physic, farewell! Where is Justinian?

[Reads]

'*Si una eademque res legatur duobus,
Alter rem, alter valorem rei*' etc.

A pretty case of paltry legacies!

[Reads]

'*Exhaereditare filium non potest pater, nisi*' –

Such is the subject of the institute,
And universal body of the law:
This study fits a mercenary drudge,
Who aims at nothing but external trash;
Too servile and illiberal for me.

When all is done, divinity is best:
Jerome's Bible, Faustus; view it well.

[Reads]

'*Stipendium peccati mors est.*'

Ha!

'*Stipendium*', etc.

The reward of sin is death. That's hard.

[Reads]

'*Si peccasse negamus, fallimur, et nulla est in nobis veritas.*'

If we say that we have no sin,
We deceive ourselves, and there is no truth in us.
Why, then, belike we must sin,
And so consequently die:
Ay, we must die an everlasting death.
What doctrine call you this? Che sera, sera,
What will be, shall be? Divinity, adieu!
[He picks up a book of magic]
These metaphysics of magicians,
And necromantic books are heavenly;
Lines, circles, scenes, letters, and characters;
Ay, these are those that Faustus most desires.
O, what a world of profit and delight,
Of power, of honour, and omnipotence
Is promised to the studious artisan!
All things that move between the quiet poles
Shall be at my command. Emperors and kings
Are but obeyed in their several provinces,
But his dominion that exceeds in this,
Stretcheth as far as does the mind of man.
A sound magician is a demigod:
Here tire my brains to get a deity.

Turn over for the next question

or

0	5
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John Webster: *The Duchess of Malfi*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of the Duchess, the Cardinal and Ferdinand
- Webster's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 1 Scene 1

FERDINAND

Now hear me:

You live in a rank pasture, here, i' the court;
There is a kind of honey-dew that's deadly;
'T will poison your fame; look to't. Be not cunning;
For they whose faces do belie their hearts
Are witches, ere they arrive at twenty years,
Ay, and give the devil suck.

DUCHESS

This is terrible good counsel.

FERDINAND

Hypocrisy is woven of a fine small thread,
Subtler than Vulcan's engine: yet, believe't,
Your darkest actions, nay, your privat'st thoughts,
Will come to light.

CARDINAL

You may flatter yourself,
And take your own choice; privately be married
Under the eaves of night –

FERDINAND

Think't the best voyage
That e'er you made; like the irregular crab,
Which, though't goes backward, thinks that it goes right
Because it goes its own way. But observe,
Such weddings may more properly be said
To be executed than celebrated.

CARDINAL

The marriage night
Is the entrance into some prison.

FERDINAND

And those joys,
Those lustful pleasures, are like heavy sleeps
Which do fore-run man's mischief.

CARDINAL

Fare you well.
Wisdom begins at the end: remember it.
[Exit]

DUCHESS

I think this speech between you both was studied,
It came so roundly off.

FERDINAND

You are my sister;
This was my father's poniard: do you see?
I'd be loth to see't look rusty, 'cause 'twas his.
I would have you give o'er these chargeable revels;
A visor and a mask are whispering-rooms
That were never built for goodness: fare ye well:
And women like that part which, like the lamprey
Hath ne'er a bone in it.

DUCHESS

Fie, sir!

FERDINAND

Nay,
I mean the tongue: variety of courtship.
What cannot a neat knave with a smooth tale
Make a woman believe? Farewell, lusty widow.
[Exit]

DUCHESS

Shall this move me? If all my royal kindred
Lay in my way unto this marriage,
I'd make them my low footsteps. And even now,
Even in this hate, as men in some great battles,
By apprehending danger, have achieved
Almost impossible actions (I have heard soldiers say so),
So I through frights and threatenings will assay
This dangerous venture. Let old wives report
I wink'd and chose a husband. Cariola,
[Enter Cariola]
To thy known secrecy I have given up
More than my life, my fame.

CARIOLA

Both shall be safe;
For I'll conceal this secret from the world
As warily as those that trade in poison
Keep poison from their children.

This extract continues on the next page

DUCHESS

Thy protestation
Is ingenious and hearty. I believe it.
Is Antonio come?

CARIOLA

He attends you.

DUCHESS

Good dear soul,
Leave me; but place thyself behind the arras,
Where thou mayst overhear us. Wish me good speed;
For I am going into a wilderness,
Where I shall find nor path nor friendly clew
To be my guide.

[Cariola withdraws behind the arras]

There are no questions printed on this page

Turn over for Section B

Section B: Later dramatic tragedies

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	6
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Arthur Miller: *Death of a Salesman*

What is the tragic and dramatic significance of Willy Loman's home in *Death of a Salesman*?

[25 marks]

or

0	7
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Tennessee Williams: *A Streetcar Named Desire*

'Blanche's fate is shown to be tragically inevitable from the opening scene of *A Streetcar Named Desire*.'

To what extent do you agree with this view of the play?

[25 marks]

or

0	8
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Henrik Ibsen: *Hedda Gabler*

'*Hedda Gabler* is a domestic tragedy whose focus is merely on domestic affairs. There are no wider or more complex human issues involved.'

To what extent do you agree with this view of the play?

[25 marks]

or

0	9
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Samuel Beckett: *Waiting for Godot*

'*Waiting for Godot* is a tragedy dominated by physical rather than mental suffering.'

To what extent do you agree with this view of the play?

[25 marks]

or

1	0
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Brian Friel: *Translations*

'*Translations* is a tragedy without a tragic hero.'

How far do you agree with this view of the play?

[25 marks]

END OF QUESTIONS

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